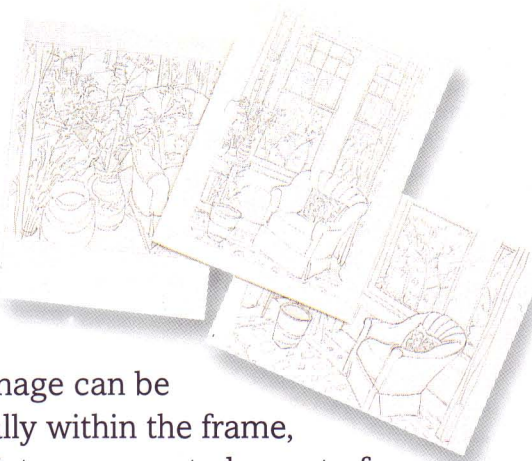


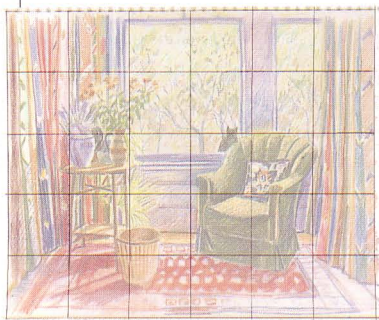
COMPOSITION

LOOKING AT A LANDSCAPE or an interior, it can be difficult to know quite where to establish the broad areas of a composition for painting. It can sometimes be helpful to think of the eye like a camera lens, zooming in on a scene to focus on just one element, or pulling back to encompass a wide viewpoint and include more visual information. You will also need to decide what the boundaries of your composition

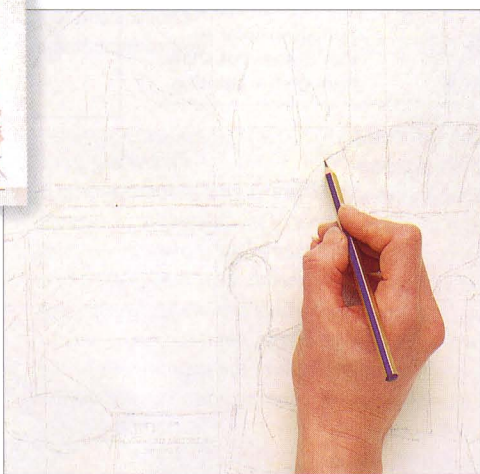
Make several sketches to discover the most interesting composition



will be. An image can be placed partially within the frame, so that the picture seems to be part of a much larger scene, or placed centrally, so that every aspect of the scene is contained within the frame. Unusual angles and perspectives can create added interest.



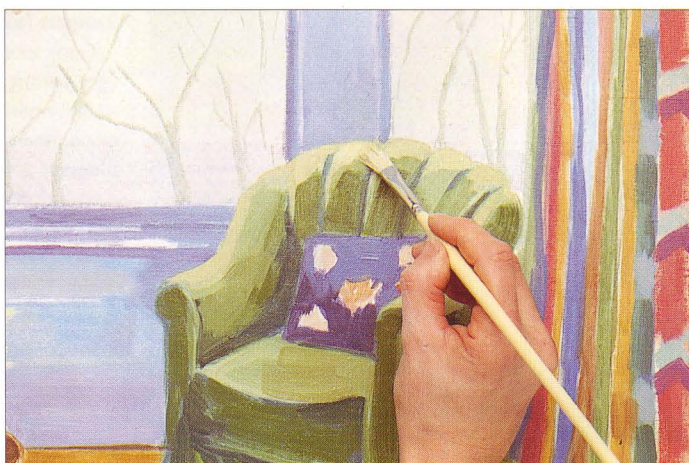
1 ▶ Select the most suitable composition and transfer the sketch onto the canvas with the aid of a drawing grid. This grid system should help you retain the correct proportions of the sketch as you draw the composition out on the canvas.



2 ▶ Block in the main elements of the composition with areas of flat color, thinned with turpentine. As this interior scene has sharp distinctions of lights and darks, try to establish these areas as soon as possible so that they stay clearly defined.



3 ▲ Build up the tones and shadows on each individual object to heighten the color and establish a sense of light. The thick stroke of dark color on this jug gives it more of a three-dimensional form.



4 ◀ Mix two separate colors to build up the lights and darks on this chair. One mix of Viridian, Cadmium Yellow, Raw Sienna, and Yellow Ochre, painted on with a medium-sized bristle brush, captures the light hitting the back of the chair. A touch of Ultramarine Blue with the Viridian gives dark shadows.